

community will provide a new normal to which you can recalibrate your life.

As you learn the stories of people who *Choose FI*, you'll quickly see the standard path has many exits that most people bypass because they don't realize they exist. Choosing FI doesn't require extreme frugality, a massive income, or special investing prowess. It starts with questioning the things that trap so many of us on the standard path and understanding that there is a different way.

Finding My Path

I began learning about personal finance by reading books and articles on my own, with no particular method to navigate all of the available information. I listened to radio show hosts like Dave Ramsey, targeted to an audience working themselves out of debt I no longer had, because that was the most readily available information, and I could listen when driving in my car.

Reading and listening gave me a basic foundation in mainstream personal finance. But my wife and I were already avoiding debt. We bought a house we could afford and were paying it off quickly. We were saving roughly 50 percent of our income, far exceeding the traditionally recommended 10 to 15 percent.